

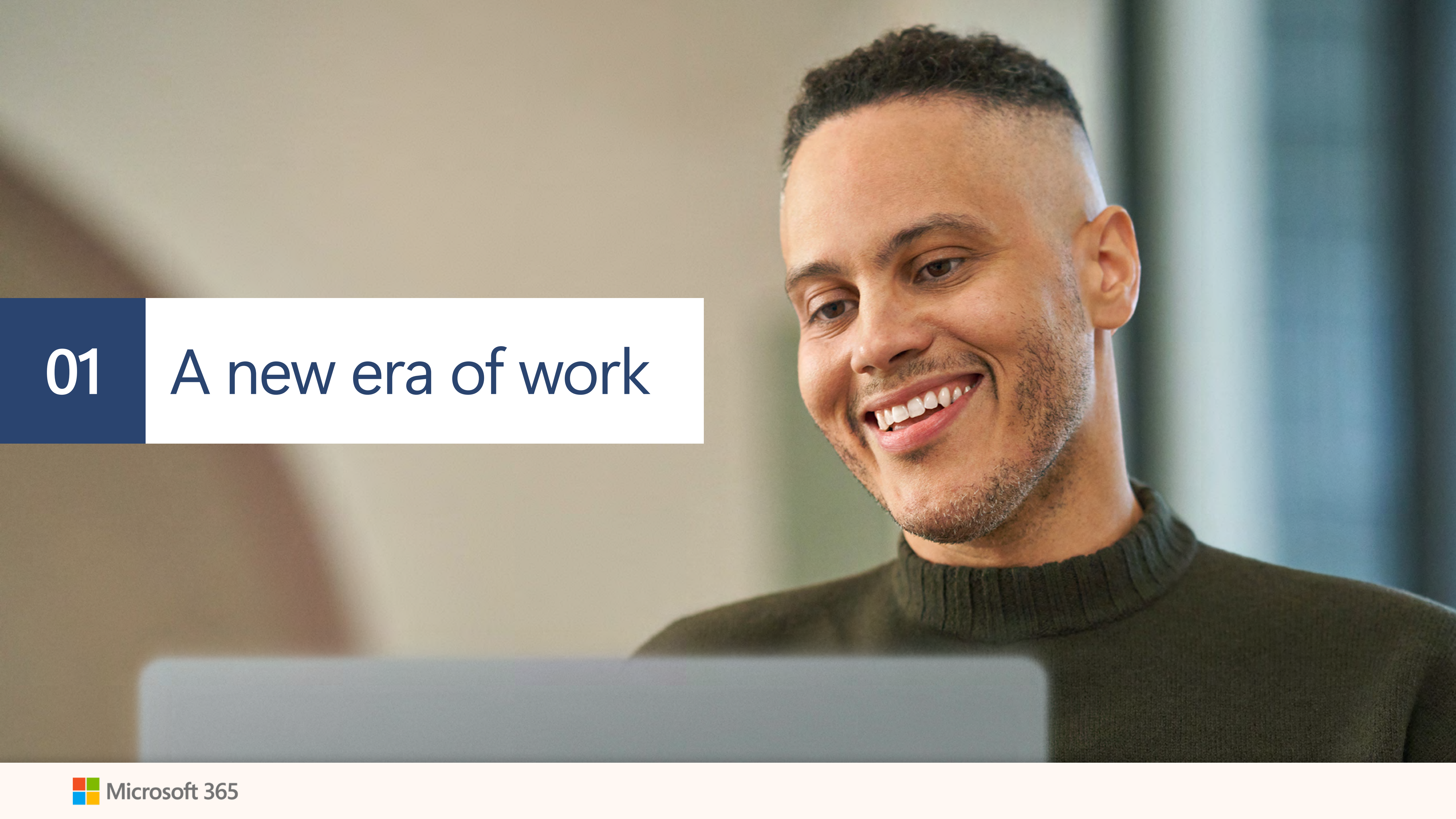
Preparing for AI

Are You Ready for a New Era of Work?



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A new era of work

Does this sound like your organisation?

68%

of people don't have enough
uninterrupted focus time.¹

62%

spend too much time
searching for information.¹

AI tools can help your employees gain
better focus and efficiency.

The era of AI-powered productivity

The way we now work – defined by an era of digital transformation – is evolving at such a pace that keeping up has become a challenge for many organisations. Business leaders are recognising the enormous opportunity that modern work solutions like AI tools present and are exploring ways to use them to their best advantage. That means implementing AI in a way that allows employees to be more engaged and productive, focusing on the work that matters most.

Organisations that made employee engagement a top priority have performed **twice as well** financially as businesses that deprioritised an engaged workforce.² And AI is poised to empower employees to be more engaged through opportunities for creativity, skill building and increased productivity. AI helps your employees offload time-consuming tasks by jump-starting the creative process, analysing trends and summarising email threads and key discussion points from meetings. Less time spent on more tedious tasks grants employees the freedom to focus on the work that matters most.

Employees are ready for AI

70%

would delegate work to AI to
lessen their workloads.²

89%

say using AI tools empowers them
to feel fulfilled and focus on the
work that matters most.³

Discover what's possible with AI

Imagine a workforce driven by the powerful combination of irreplaceable human ingenuity and skill with the innovative capabilities of a secure, user-friendly AI system. With the right tools and mindset, any organisation can embrace the transformation to an AI-powered workforce.

Responsible AI practices

With all the potential that working with AI holds, it's critical to remember to take an approach that prioritises fairness, transparency and accountability. Microsoft is a leader in the development and implementation of AI systems, which includes creating guidance on principles and best practices for responsible AI use – and ensuring those principles are at the foundation of Microsoft's AI technology. Only with responsible AI implementation can your organisation unlock the full potential of what's possible with AI.

02 AI readiness

How do you know your organisation is ready for AI?

The platform shift to AI isn't one that can be made without clear leadership and focused investment. Implementing AI technology can be complex, especially without a well-defined plan in place. It requires a culture of productivity and collaboration, a secure foundation for endpoint management and the willingness to embrace change in order to outpace it.

What does AI readiness look like?

An organisation ready to embrace AI understands its potential as a strategic asset, how it can be used to benefit the business and the ability to guide employees and customers in responsible AI practices. Assessing your readiness level is the first step toward transforming your organisation into one that can outpace the changes and challenges of this new era of working with next-generation technologies like AI.

A photograph of two men in an office environment. One man, wearing a blue sweater, is pointing at a laptop screen. The other man, seen from the side, is looking at the screen. The background shows a window with a view of a city.

03 Assessment

Assessment:

Evaluating your AI readiness

To help you begin the transformation to an AI-powered organisation, we've compiled a quiz with questions aimed at evaluating readiness level. The quiz is in five parts and assesses your organisation's:

- Relationship to change and productivity
- Relationship to AI
- Willingness to use AI
- Investment and funding abilities
- Endpoint management and security capabilities

Each question has three potential answers. Choose the one that sounds most like where your organisation currently stands and keep a tally of your answers as you go. At the end of the quiz, you'll be able to estimate whether your organisation is **Very Ready**, **Almost Ready**, or **Needs More Guidance** to begin the transformation to an AI-powered workforce.



Part One:

Your organisation's
relationship to change
and productivity

Rate your organisation's openness to change and innovation.

- A **Very open:** We welcome and seek out opportunities for change and innovation.
- B **Somewhat open:** We approach opportunities for change and innovation with caution.
- C **Not very open:** We don't take on many opportunities for change and innovation.

How confident are you that your current technology empowers your employees to be productive?

- A **Very confident:** Our technology greatly improves employee productivity.
- B **Somewhat confident:** Our technology somewhat improves employee productivity.
- C **Not very confident:** Our technology does not support employee productivity.

Part Two:

Your organisation's relationship to AI

How fundamental is AI to the success of your business?

- A **Very important:** AI will greatly improve the success of our business.
- B **Somewhat important:** AI will support the success of our business, but it isn't necessary.
- C **Not very important:** AI would be beneficial in other ways, but won't affect the success of our business.

Rate your employees' current willingness to adopt new technologies, including AI.

- A **Very willing:** Employees are excited to learn about and use new technologies like AI.
- B **Somewhat willing:** Employees are cautiously optimistic about new technologies.
- C **Not very willing:** Employees are resistant to new technologies, including AI.

Part Three:

Your organisation's willingness to use AI

How important is it to provide secure, user-friendly AI systems to your workforce?

- A** **Very important:** We want our employees to be able to learn and use AI as soon as possible.
- B** **Somewhat important:** We're interested in adopting user-friendly AI, but want to learn more first.
- C** **Not very important:** User-friendly AI systems are a 'nice-to-have', but not currently a priority.

How much, if at all, has your organisation's leadership bought into the business value of AI-powered tools?

- A** **All in:** Our leadership is ready and willing to begin transitioning to AI-powered tools.
- B** **Somewhat in:** Leadership understands the importance of AI, but needs some convincing on the business value of adopting it.
- C** **Not at all in:** Our leadership doesn't understand the importance or value of AI just yet.

Part Four:

Investment and funding

How strong is your investment in change management and training to support the transition to AI-powered processes and systems?

- A **Very strong:** We could begin the transition immediately.
- B **Somewhat strong:** We could begin the transition soon but have some challenges to overcome first.
- C **Not very strong:** We need a lot of support and training before we can begin the transition to AI.

Does your organisation have funding for deploying and implementing a secure, user-friendly AI system?

- A **Fully funded:** Our organisation is ready and able to invest in AI technologies.
- B **Some funding:** Our organisation can afford to transition, but leadership is unsure the benefit outweighs the cost.
- C **No funding:** We're working toward a place where we can invest in AI technologies, but we're not quite there yet.

Part Five:

Endpoint management and security capabilities

How confident are you in your organisation’s current endpoint management capabilities to enable employees to use AI to help them do their best work, regardless of where they work and what device they use?

- A **Very confident:** Our endpoint management capabilities allow employees to work where and how they feel they can be most successful.
- B **Somewhat confident:** Our endpoint management capabilities are stable for certain experiences, but could be improved.
- C **Not very confident:** We need a better system to support endpoint management for employees working anywhere and from any device.

Rate your organisation’s current security foundation for enabling AI-powered work from any endpoint.

- A **Very secure:** Our systems are built on a robust security foundation and support our strong endpoint management capabilities.
- B **Somewhat secure:** We have strong security systems, but aren’t confident they can support the additional requirements of using AI-powered tools.
- C **Not very secure:** We need a more secure system to protect our organisation’s data and ensure our employees can confidently work from anywhere.

04 Results

Very Ready

Mostly 'A's

GREAT NEWS: Your organisation is ready to get your AI transformation underway. The Microsoft 365 team is excited to help you move forward. A couple of key notes for **Very Ready** organisations:

- If you haven't deployed Microsoft 365 yet, we can help make that happen so your organisation is set up with a Zero Trust foundation and strong endpoint management capabilities. Having that baseline productivity in place will enable your employees to start exploring the benefits of Copilot as soon as possible. You can find a link to get started at the end of this eBook.
- Before you can subscribe to **Microsoft 365 Copilot**, you need a qualifying Microsoft 365 subscription.* You can accelerate your employees workflows using Microsoft Copilot with commercial data protection when logged in with your Entra ID. If you're just interested in taking advantage of free capabilities, you can experience Microsoft Copilot by signing in with an MSA.

Almost Ready

Mostly 'B's

GOOD NEWS: Your organisation is nearly there. Like **Very Ready** organisations, your **Almost Ready** business should consider deploying a qualifying Microsoft 365 subscription* if you haven't already. Help your employees learn their way around Microsoft 365, its best-in-class productivity apps, Zero Trust security, device and app management and robust collaboration capabilities. This will make it easier for them to adopt the AI integrations down the road. A couple of notes for **Almost Ready** organisations:

- There is a wealth of guidance online to help you familiarise your teams with **Microsoft AI** capabilities before deploying the tools.
- Microsoft 365 representatives are available to help you understand what steps specific to your organisation will take you from **Almost Ready** to **Very Ready**.

Need More Guidance

Mostly 'C's

IT'S OK: It sounds like your organisation could benefit from personalised guidance on implementing AI tools. For more information on the requirements and benefits of a secure, user-friendly AI system, Microsoft can help! A couple of notes to get organisations that **Need More Guidance** started:

- Speak to a Microsoft 365 representative to learn more about the benefits of adopting Microsoft 365 so your organisation can build a foundation that will get you **Very Ready** for AI transformation.
- Visit the **Microsoft AI homepage** for a number of resources on responsible AI principles, specific AI capabilities and guidance on how to build an AI-ready organisation.

Continue reading for next steps

A woman with curly blonde hair is smiling and looking towards the left. She is wearing a grey ribbed top. In the background, another person is partially visible, looking in the same direction. The scene appears to be indoors with large windows.

05

Next steps

Unlock the potential of AI with Microsoft 365 Copilot

An organisation ready to unlock what's possible with AI has a strong foundation in security, streamlined endpoint management and an openness to innovation that improves productivity. With Microsoft 365, your organisation can achieve those checkpoints with one complete solution. Microsoft 365 ensures your organisation's technology landscape will be grounded in Zero Trust, ensuring a secure foundation for all of your endpoints, no matter where access is coming from. A Zero Trust security foundation in turn makes endpoint management safer and less complex, so you can efficiently grant employees access to all the tools they need to be more productive than ever.

Microsoft offers decades in future-forward technology expertise, and that experience is built into the features that make Microsoft 365 so powerful. Now, when you add Microsoft 365 Copilot* to your organisation, you'll extend the capabilities of its productivity apps even

further. Microsoft 365 delivers a secure, productive working experience. With Microsoft 365 Copilot, it becomes an intuitive, next-generation productivity partner that works alongside your employees, empowering them to collaborate and work more efficiently to become more productive contributors to business outcomes.

Microsoft 365 Copilot can empower your team to tap into the rich functionality available throughout Microsoft 365, making employees better at what they're already good at and mastering what they've yet to learn. It integrates seamlessly with the apps your teams already use and is designed to unlock their untapped potential. Ultimately, Microsoft 365 Copilot elevates the powerful capabilities of Microsoft 365 to enhance your workforce's productivity, creativity and skills – benefits your organisation can experience when you make the transformation to AI.

What does Microsoft 365 Copilot deliver for your organisation?



Secure any endpoint with robust protocols grounded in Zero Trust



Automate time-consuming, repetitive tasks so employees can focus on more meaningful work



Reduce your organisation's software footprint



Lower costs of deployment and implementation



Improve employee productivity and engagement



Drive higher financial performance and positive business outcomes

What does Microsoft 365 Copilot deliver for your organisation?

*** Disclaimer:**

Microsoft 365 Copilot may not be available for all markets and languages. To purchase, customers must have a qualifying Microsoft 365 plan for [enterprise](#) or [business](#).

Sources:

- 1 'Will AI Fix Work?' Work Trend Index, May 9, 2023. Microsoft. <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/will-ai-fix-work>.
- 2 'The New Performance Equation in the Age of AI.' Work Trend Index, April 20, 2023. Microsoft. <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/the-new-performance-equation-in-the-age-of-ai>.
- 3 'A Whole New Way of Working.' Work Trend Index. Microsoft. <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/ai-a-whole-new-way-of-working>.



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